



ULKOASIAINMINISTERIÖ

ERITYISOHJEET

PRIVILEGED INSTRUCTIONS

**Ministry of Foreign Affairs
REPUBLIC OF FINLAND**

Ulkoministeriö
Ministry of Foreign



Utrikesministeriet
Affairs of Finland

Privileged Instructions

Fundamental Principles

- Finland will be an active and responsible Arctic actor.
- Finland's diversified Arctic experience is set to assist in the development of the region.

Desired End States

- PRIMARY: Strengthen the delicate balance between our relations with Russia and our inclusion in the EU and NATO.
- ALTERNATE: International cooperation in the sustainable and peaceful development of the Arctic is key.

Primary Guidance Background

The expertise Finns have in sustainable development, the maritime industry, and mineral extraction places us in an advantageous position to provide leadership in these areas to other Arctic states.

Delegation Instructions

Ensure periodic reports, requests for further guidance, or clarifications to the instructions herein are submitted via message to the office of the Foreign Minister.

GENERAL: Below are our negotiation positions during this conference. Deviations from these instructions are to be conferred with the Foreign Minister prior to negotiating.

As hosts of this Arctic dialog conference we must be gracious. Welcome each delegation and work with the Special Representative to ensure a positive and substantive conference.

We have served as an intermediary between Russia and the EU for diplomatic dialog in the past. Utilize our unique position and try to bring Russia into dialog with nations regarding the EU Arctic policy and agreements. We may be one of the only ways to include Russia in multilateral dialog. Don't consider this being against our stance on Russia as a threat to our peoples. Having a long border with them dictates that we must work with them to "lower the temperature" regarding talks between all of our nations.

Work with Denmark, as a fellow EU member state, to promote the delineation of the Arctic as a 'global commons'. China holds the same stance on the Arctic. There may be common ground with them both to balance the Arctic Five and their control of High Arctic policy.

Since our NATO accession application our trade with Russia has experienced unprecedented declines with a nearly 75% drop in trade. Attempt to secure new outlets for our goods and services with non-EU states to make up for these trade declines.

Territory

We have considerable interest in the Arctic. We have a duty to protect our nation against Russian aggression as well as maintain control over our territory. Without being an Arctic Ocean coastal nation we have no disputes regarding the continental shelf discussion. This fact may afford us the role of intermediary for Arctic coastal nations. Use our "neutrality" on this issue to work a resolution among coastal states.

Militarization

The increased militarization of the Arctic threatens the current peace and stability in the region. With the growing access to seaways and thawing of traditionally permafrost areas military operations are becoming easier to conduct.

Our accession into NATO provides added security guarantees that we previously didn't require. Russia's invasion of Ukraine demonstrated how fragile our relationship is with them. We still may be the only western delegation to be able to dialog with Russia.

We need to work, through international organizations, to ensure peace continues. As a link between Russia and NATO we have influence on both to help ease tensions. Through the Arctic Council we must continue to emphasize demilitarizing the Arctic and resolving differences through dialog and diplomacy and not through might.

However, we have increased our military budget for the coming years to ensure that we are able to defend ourselves. Increased capability in cyber, air defense, and surveillance are our top priorities. We rely on our interoperability with the rest of Scandinavia to protect against any potential Russian aggression. We can provide NATO with our cold climate expertise, and we are well-placed to offer Arctic training and exercises to our international partners.

Along with Norway, we fear an American overreaction to increased Chinese and Russian activities in the Arctic. As the country with the longest border with Russia (of the Arctic states) the potential fallout from such a reaction could directly affect our sovereignty.

Through the Arctic Council we must continue to emphasize demilitarizing the Arctic and resolving differences through dialog and diplomacy and not through might. Along with Iceland we agree that security issues must be discussed in the Arctic Council. With recent actions in the Arctic, we feel that there isn't a suitable venue to discuss security. The Arctic Council is the only logical place to have such discussions.

Resources

We are a pioneer in sustainable mining in the Arctic. Expertise in mine water management and geotechnological engineering will be further underlined in the face of climate change. We have a strong interest in participating in the energy business operations in the Arctic region, which will also have an impact on demand for our various products and services.

With increased interest in Arctic resources the potential for disputes of territory and resource claims increases. As nations seek to improve their claims, outside of their UNCLOS defined EEZs, overlapping areas come in to conflict.

We are uniquely suited to help other Arctic states in developing their resource extractions. Use this capability to foster closer bilateral ties with Denmark, Norway, and Russia. The potential economic benefits for our country are great and can lead to less tensions with neighbors.

Economic development must be tailored with resource management and conservation. The Arctic commercial fishing opportunities are growing. Overfishing and protection of endangered species must be controlled by an international effort of concerned nations. At the same time oil and gas exploration and extraction must ensure pollution-free operation and nations/companies be prepared to respond to any situation.

However, along with Iceland and Sweden have been left out of Arctic Ocean policy discussions by the Arctic Five. As members of the Arctic Council, we feel that all Arctic issues should be resolved through the dialog mechanism. The commercial fishing restrictions place undue strain on our commercial fishing operations.

Environment

Preservation of the fragile Arctic ecosystem is at risk due to climate change, increased human traffic, and resource extraction. Efforts to extract the resources beneath the Arctic Ocean must be done with an effort towards minimal ecological impact and environmental protection. This balance must be done by all Arctic nations to ensure the whole region is developed smartly.

The marine ecosystem is still not completely understood. With the recent banning of commercial fishing, in the Arctic high seas, time will allow further study and understanding of this resource.

Our policy in adapting to climate change is to evaluate and manage the risks of climate change, promoting the measures required to develop renewable natural resources, and the stewardship of water resources.

All nations must adhere to the Paris Climate Agreement and take further actions to reduce carbon emissions. The delicate tundra of Northern Finland has been greatly affected by climate change. In order preserve this ecosystem we insist that China and the U.S., the two largest carbon emitters, take more aggressive action to reduce their carbon footprint.

Canada ranks 7th in oil production yet claims to be very concerned about the environment and global warming. Norway, ranked 15th, has promoted environmental sustainability while continuing to extract and export oil around the world. Stating 'green' policies on one hand and yet economically benefiting off of the largest environmental threat is very hypocritical.

Governance

The Arctic Council was formed as a high-level forum to provide means for promoting cooperation, coordination, and interaction among the Arctic states. Key elements of governance and security are not discussed during council sessions. As the only fully inclusive Arctic organization we feel that security discussions should be allowed on a limited basis.

Our objective is to bolster our position as an Arctic country and to reinforce international Arctic cooperation. We consider the Arctic Council as the main forum for addressing Arctic issues. We encourage the Council's dialog with external organizations and states. The inclusion of new observers who are committed to the same goals of the Council are only seen as a benefit.

We support EU full observer status on the Arctic Council. As an EU member state we see the whole of Europe as having interest in the development of the Arctic. It is logical to include Brussels on the Arctic Council with the full observer status benefits.

We do not support China's accession to full member state status on the Arctic Council. These positions on the Council should be reserved for Arctic states only. No matter how much interest in,

or investment in, the Arctic, China is not an Arctic state. The Ottawa Declaration clearly states that members are “the Arctic States” which China clearly is not.

We do not think that the Arctic Five should exclude us, Iceland, and Sweden. Decisions regarding the Arctic involve, and affect, all Arctic states. We all declared, in Ottawa, the desire to “provide for regular intergovernmental consideration of and consultation on Arctic issues.” When the Arctic Five ignores our participation it does not keep good faith with the founding principles of the Arctic Council.

Red Line:

Any attempt to make China a member state of the Arctic Council.

Population

The Sámi (Saami) are the only Indigenous peoples in the EU. Their status in Finland is guaranteed in our Constitution. With such a large Sámi population in Finland we seek to ensure their participation in areas that would affect their status and way of life.

We find it important that Indigenous peoples’ organisations are represented in the Arctic Council. We encourage their participation in the work the Council does at a variety of levels. We have included the Sámi in our Parliament and they have representation across our Nordic Council membership.